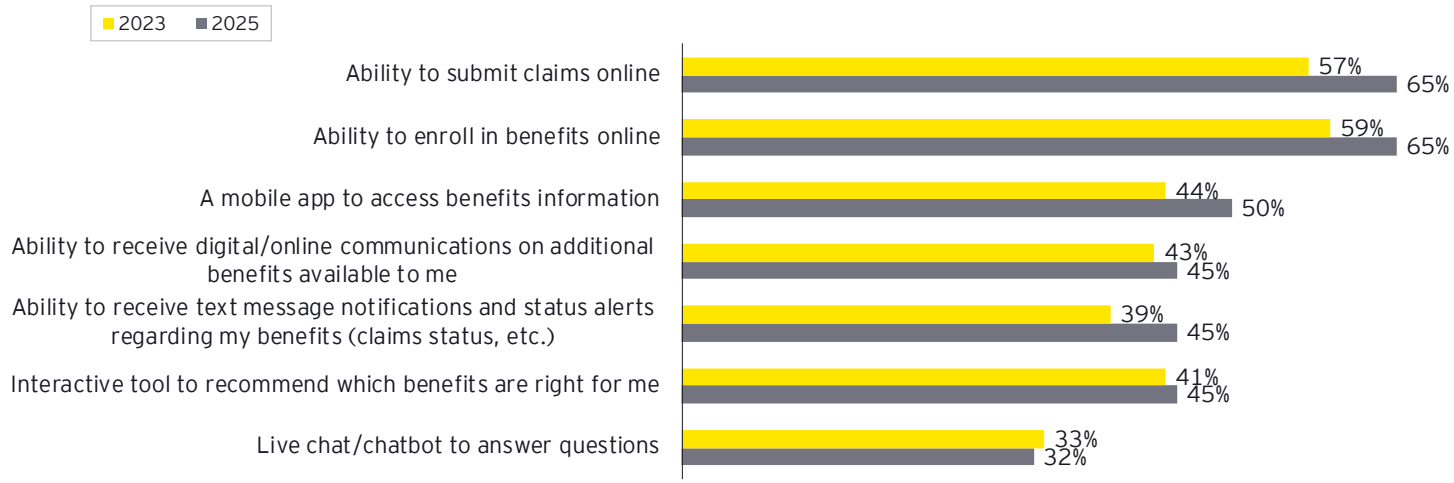
Planning digital enhancements: In addition to pressure from employers and brokers, further enhancements to digital experiences are necessary to satisfy rising employee expectations and new work models. Indeed, employee interest in digital capabilities has widely increased since our 2023 study, with online enrollment and claims submission topping the list, likely driven by continued growth of younger generations in the workforce. Mobile apps and text messaging are particularly appealing to younger workers. *See Figure 15.*

Figure 15

Employees want claims and enrollment processes to be further digitized.

QUESTION: How important is it to have the following digital/online capabilities available to you?



Note: Data represents the percentage of respondents reporting importance as "very much."

In terms of technology source, third-party providers (e.g., benefits platforms, software vendors) were identified as best positioned to deliver the necessary technology to drive digital enhancements. Many employers also see carriers and brokers as viable tech providers, with very low interest levels around in-house or homegrown solutions. *See Figure 16.*

Figure 16

Third-party vendors are best positioned to provide benefits technology.

QUESTION: Which of the following do you feel is best positioned to provide the most important benefits technology for your company's insurance benefits program?

